

Assessment Brief

Module Code and Title: EC4007 –Fundamentals of Economics

Assessment Title: Portfolio - Individual Applied Economics Portfolio

Weighting: 100%

Word Count: 2,500 words (+/- 10%)

Submission Deadline: 20/04/2026 By 12 Noon (via Turnitin)

Purpose of the Assessment

This assessment is designed to develop your ability to **apply core economic concepts, theories, and tools** to a **real-world business context**, using **credible data and evidence**.

Through this portfolio, you will demonstrate how economic thinking can be used to:

- Analyse business decisions and market conditions
- Interpret microeconomic and macroeconomic data
- Evaluate government policies and economic environments
- Make evidence-based recommendations

The assessment supports the development of **analytical, data-handling, and professional communication skills** essential for further study in economics, business, and related disciplines.

Assessment Context

You have been appointed as a **junior economic analyst** to evaluate the economic feasibility of **Greggs plc's UK expansion strategy**.

Greggs operates in a challenging economic environment characterised by:

- High inflation and volatile input prices
- Labour shortages and wage pressures
- Changing consumer demand
- Government intervention and macroeconomic uncertainty

Your task is to prepare an **applied economics portfolio** using economic theory, diagrams, and **real UK data** to advise whether Greggs should **continue, slow, or adjust** its expansion strategy.

Assessment Task

You are required to produce an **individual analytical portfolio** that applies **microeconomic and macroeconomic analysis** to the Greggs case study.

Your portfolio must:

- Apply relevant **economic theories and models**
- Use **real UK economic data** from credible sources
- Include **original graphs, charts, tables, and diagrams**
- Analyse business decisions within the wider economic environment
- Provide a **final, evidence-based economic recommendation**
- Include short **reflective elements** demonstrating your learning

Use of AI

AI tools may be used for proofreading and improving clarity of expression AI must not be used to generate analysis or conclusions or to replace independent judgement.

Suggested Portfolio Structure

You may use the following structure as guidance:

1. Introduction
2. Part 1: Economic & Business Environment (PESTLE + macro data)
3. Part 2: Microeconomics (demand, elasticity, competition, pricing)
4. Part 3: Factor Markets (labour, wages, energy, wheat)
5. Part 4: Macroeconomic Policy & Expansion Feasibility
6. Part 5: Final Reflection
7. Conclusion

Sources and Referencing

You are expected to use:

- lecture materials
- academic and credible government sources where appropriate (e.g. textbooks, World bank, ONS, Bank of England)

All sources must be referenced using **Harvard referencing**.

Process-Based Development (Formative Tasks)

This assessment is supported through **structured formative activities** scheduled across the module. These activities are designed to help you prepare your portfolio progressively, using guidance and feedback before final submission.

Weekly Formative Tasks (Weeks 2–8)

In each workshop, you will complete short in-class activities linked to the week's economic focus.

These include:

- Constructing supply and demand diagrams for different market scenarios
- Identifying and interpreting key UK economic indicators (CPI, GDP, wage growth, interest rates)
- Analysing elasticity using real or simulated data
- Completing short PESTLE exercises for business environment analysis
- Working in Excel to create economic charts (inflation trends, labour market data, commodity prices)

All tasks will be supported by tutor guidance and discussion. These sessions are designed to build your confidence with economic tools, models, and data, and prepare you for completing each section of the portfolio.

Formative Draft Submission (Week 9) (27/3/2026) By 12 Noon

In **Week 9**, you will submit a **draft version of your portfolio** as part of the **formative portfolio draft submission** covering:

- PESTLE table and initial macroeconomic graph
- Draft microeconomic diagram (e.g., elasticity or market structure)
- Early analysis of competition, pricing, or factor markets
- Initial data tables (inflation, wages, input prices)
- Preliminary reflections on how economic theory supports your analysis

Feedback provided at this stage is developmental and intended to help you improve your work before the final submission.

Only the final report submitted in Week 12 (20/04/2026) by 12 Noon is graded.

Formative tasks and drafts do not carry marks.

Learning Outcomes Assessed

By completing this assessment, you will be able to demonstrate:

- LO1 – Demonstrate understanding of the assumptions, logical structure, implications and limitations of core economic concepts, theories and ideas.
- LO2 – Demonstrate knowledge regarding the nature and development of key economic institutions and socio-economic structures affecting business, national and global economies.
- LO3 – Critically evaluate the relevance of economic theories and concepts in relation to institutional and policy contexts.
- LO4 – Apply economic theories and tools to analyse business decisions, government policy, and economic performance.
- LO5 – Gather, analyse, and evaluate qualitative and quantitative data to draw evidence-based economic conclusions.

Marking Criteria (summary)

Criterion	What this means	Weight
Understanding of Economic Concepts & Theory	How well you demonstrate understanding of core economic concepts and theories (such as scarcity, demand and supply, elasticity, market structures, and macroeconomic policy). You should explain ideas accurately, use correct economic terminology, and show clear understanding rather than simply naming concepts.	20%
Application of Economic Models & Tools	How effectively you apply economic models and tools, such as diagrams, graphs, tables, and analytical frameworks. Diagrams should be original, clearly labelled, and explained in your own words, showing how they help analyse the business situation.	20%
Economic Analysis & Evaluation	How well you analyse and evaluate the economic environment and business decisions. This includes explaining why economic conditions matter, how they affect costs, demand, pricing, or expansion decisions, and evaluating risks, trade-offs, and implications using economic reasoning.	25%
Use and Interpretation of Data	How appropriately you select, present, and interpret qualitative and quantitative data from credible sources (such as ONS, Bank of England, or HM Treasury). Marks are awarded for explaining what the data shows and why it is relevant, not for including large amounts of data.	20%

Criterion	What this means	Weight
Professional Communication & Referencing	How clearly and professionally you structure and present your work. This includes logical organisation, clear academic writing, correct use of figures and tables, and accurate Harvard referencing throughout the portfolio.	15%

The marking rubric is provided in the appendix.

Weight	Band E (39% or Lower)	Band D (40–59%)	Band C (60–69%)	Band B (70-79%)	Band A (80% or Higher)
Criterion					
Understanding of Core Economic Concepts & Theories 20%	Demonstrates limited understanding of core economic concepts and theories. Explanations contain significant inaccuracies or misconceptions that limit meaningful application.	Demonstrates basic understanding of core concepts and theories. Explanations are generally correct but remain descriptive and lack depth or clarity.	Demonstrates competent understanding of key economic concepts and theories. Explanations are mostly accurate, though depth or precision may vary.	Demonstrates strong understanding of economic concepts and theories. Explanations are accurate, clear, and appropriately applied to the context.	Demonstrates excellent and confident understanding of economic concepts and theories, including assumptions and limitations, applied accurately and insightfully.
Application of Economic Models, Diagrams & Tools 20%	Use of economic models, diagrams, or tools is limited or inaccurate. Diagrams or calculations contain errors that reduce their usefulness.	Economic models and diagrams are used at a basic level. Some accuracy is evident, though labelling, explanation, or application is underdeveloped.	Economic models, diagrams, and tools are applied competently and mostly accurately. Explanations support understanding, though integration may be uneven.	Economic models, diagrams, and tools are applied accurately and clearly. Diagrams are well-labelled and effectively support the analysis.	Economic models, diagrams, and analytical tools are applied accurately, confidently, and effectively, demonstrating strong analytical control and clarity.
Economic Analysis & Evaluation of Business and Policy Contexts 25%	Analysis is largely descriptive, with limited evaluation of business conditions or policy impacts. Contextual links are insufficient.	Provides basic analysis of business or policy contexts. Some evaluation is evident, though reasoning is limited and largely descriptive.	Provides sound analysis of business and policy contexts, with relevant evaluation. Links between theory, data, and context are present but not fully developed.	Provides clear and well-developed analysis of business and policy contexts. Evaluation demonstrates good understanding of economic implications.	Provides insightful and comprehensive economic analysis, critically evaluating business and policy contexts with strong integration of theory, data, and evidence.
Presentation and Interpretation of Economic Data 20%	Use of data is minimal or inappropriate. Interpretation is limited, and charts or tables do not effectively support analysis.	Uses data at a basic level. Some interpretation is evident, though presentation or explanation may be unclear or incomplete.	Uses relevant qualitative and quantitative data competently. Interpretation is generally sound, though depth or clarity may vary.	Uses and interprets economic data effectively. Charts, tables, and graphs are clear, accurate, and well integrated into the analysis.	Uses a wide range of relevant economic data effectively and critically. Data selection, interpretation, and presentation strongly support the analysis.
Professional Communication, Structure & Referencing 15%	Structure and academic communication are insufficient. Arguments are unclear, and referencing is inconsistent or largely absent.	Demonstrates basic structure and communication. Writing is generally understandable, though organisation and referencing are inconsistent.	Demonstrates clear structure and appropriate academic style. Referencing is present and generally accurate, with minor inconsistencies.	Demonstrates professional academic communication. Structure is clear, arguments are coherent, and referencing is mostly accurate and consistent.	Demonstrates a high standard of professional academic communication. Structure is coherent throughout, writing is clear and precise, and referencing is accurate and consistently applied.